

"Companies and traders are selling inferior quality products in the market, which is affecting the growth of the market and misguiding customers. Government needs to set standards for security devices that can be sold and provide guidelines for import of electronic security products in India."



—**Sanjeev Sehgal**, chairman, Security Promotion Group of India (SPGI), and managing director, Sparsh

unorganised with many traders flooding the market with inferior imported products.

Lack of awareness. Customers need to be educated so that they can buy the right product and technology for their security needs and get the best return on their investment. Today, security products are sold as boxes without caring for the overall benefits that customers expect. Many customers mistakenly equate products with solutions. Higher customer awareness and better responsibility on part of manufacturers and their system integrators would improve customer satisfaction.

Lack of uniform quality standards. Currently, there are no quality parameters defined to sell CCTV products. In the absence of any regulatory body governing the standards, a lot of misspelling is happening in the market.

Inflow of counterfeit products. A strong initiative from the government's side is required to curb spurious practices and provide quality and durable products in the market.

Moving towards Make in India

India consumes so many security and surveillance products that there is a growing need to manufacture these products in India. Moreover, the new amended PMA policy on 100 per cent preference to Made in India products for procurement of CCTV cameras (video) and sensor based alarm systems by all government departments and projects like

STRENGTHS

- Remote and continuous monitoring systems
- Advent of compact security devices
- Integration of new technologies like light detection and ranging (LIDAR) technology and high-quality oblique images
- Versatility and customisation of products at affordable rates
- Increasing IP infrastructure

WEAKNESSES

- Less number of sessions/workshops by industries on the installation of the security and surveillance equipment
- Industry's reliability on small and quality PCBs and availability of multi-layered and other quality PCBs along with some discrete components is a problem
- Lack of awareness about the installation of security equipment
- Dearth of suppliers of quality components required for security and surveillance products

SWOT

OPPORTUNITIES

- Increase in the number of terrorist attacks and criminal activities
- Increasing number of hi-tech public infrastructure
- Growing awareness
- Integrating mobile and cloud services with surveillance devices

THREATS

- Low import duty
- Inflow of low-cost security and surveillance products is high
- Inflow of low quality products
- Inferior quality products sold with incorrect information

SWOT analysis of the surveillance industry

city surveillance, public transport surveillance and police station surveillance are expected to boost domestic manufacturing further. Though in the present scenario there is clear gap between Make in India campaign and the security and surveillance industry.

"The fundamental reason for this can be attributed to the lack of an ecosystem. India has a lot of demand and customers, but to manufacture such products a basic ecosystem is required, which is lacking at present. The government is trying to address this issue of the lack of an ecosystem through Make in India campaign, but its effectiveness can only be ascertained after a period of time. If the security and surveillance, and telecom and IT industries start making in India, only then the manufacturing ecosystem in the country could take off.

"I believe that heavy industries like defence cannot contribute hugely to this initiative as a lot of parts will be imported or outsourced. Since it will be the assembly of products, value addition will be negligible and knowledge sharing

cannot be taken to another level.

"If Make in India has to be made successful, a lot of focus should be given to telecom, IT, consumer electronics and video surveillance industries. Small industries are the key to develop the manufacturing ecosystem in India," says Jivani.

According to Sehgal, "It is very encouraging to see the government committed to domestic manufacturing. Make in India and such other initiatives will create two-dimensional growth opportunities for the security industry in India."

While discussing the effectiveness of these initiatives, he suggests:

1. The government needs to have well-defined policies for the industry pertaining to imports, quality control, tax structure and preference to Indian manufacturers.
2. The government needs to be absolutely transparent in large-size government tenders.
3. Since the major chunk of the business comes from the government sector, both state and central government departments need to allocate and spend funds to keep the industries going. **EFY**